

# Aspire Globalink

India's Leading  
**Dairy Brands**  
— To Watch In —  
**2025**

*Leading Legacy and  
Heritage Towards  
Global Recognition*



*Mr.* **Arun Dongale**  
*Chairman – Gokul*



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## ■ *Editor's Note*

**A**t **Aspire GlobalLink**, we take pride in recognizing brands that exemplify excellence, leadership, and impact across industries. In this edition, we bring you the remarkable journey of one of India's most trusted dairy cooperatives **Gokul Milk**.

Established in **1963** as a grassroots movement to empower rural dairy farmers, Gokul Milk has transformed into a leading force in India's dairy sector. Today, under the visionary leadership of **Shri Arun Ganpatrao Dongale**, Gokul handles over **17 lakh liters** of milk daily and boasts a **turnover of ₹3,670 crore**, making it a true symbol of cooperative strength and modern enterprise.

Through innovative farmer first initiatives, state of the art processing, sustainability projects like biogas and solar energy, and a strong presence across Maharashtra and beyond, Gokul continues to raise the bar in quality, scale, and social impact.

In this edition, we are proud to showcase the journey, values, and vision of **Kolhapur Zilla Sahakari Dudh Utpadak Sangh Ltd.**, popularly known as Gokul. As one of **India's Leading Dairy Brands To Watch In 2025**, Gokul represents the perfect harmony of rural strength and modern enterprise.

*Happy Reading!*

*Editorial Team, Aspire GlobalLink*



## *Creator Page*

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**Story Curated By**  
Aditya Bhandari  
Founder, Aspire Globallink

**Editorial Team**  
**Content & Research**  
Piyush Mhetar

**Graphic Designer**  
Rohan Patil

**Web Development & Maintenance.**  
Mohini Fatak

*Follow us on*



✉ [aditya@aspiregloballink.com](mailto:aditya@aspiregloballink.com)

📍 2nd Floor Of Bhandare Cloth Centre, Bidri, Kolhapur. 416208





COVER STORY





## A LEGACY ROOTED IN RURAL GRIT (1963–1985)

The story began in 1963, in the freshly independent India, when village women from Kolhapur's outskirts would carry milk and curd in pots, trudging through the city streets. There was no structured market, no fair price only determination. Visionaries like Anandrao Patil Chouker and N.T. Sarnaik laid the foundation of a cooperative model that would empower dairy producers and organize milk marketing under one umbrella.

Milk was initially collected on bicycles, in traditional pots, and sold to local dairies and customers. As demand and collection grew, Gokul underwent formal restructuring in 1971, becoming a district-level cooperative.

By 1975, with support from Dr. Verghese Kurien and the NDDB, Gokul became part of Operation Flood India's White Revolution. Chilling centers in Gadhinglaj (1981) and Bidri (1983), and the Mahalaxmi Cattle Feed Plant (1981), laid the foundation of a thriving dairy infrastructure.

**Arun  
Ganpatrao  
Dongale**  
Chairman







## Scaling Heights with Cooperative Power (1985–2005)

In **1985**, with the support of **Chief Minister Sharad Pawar**, the Kolhapur Dairy was transferred to the Gokul Milk Union. A modern dairy complex was inaugurated at **Gokul Shirgaon**, and within two years, Gokul hit the milestone of **200,000 liters/day** milk collection.

From **glass bottles to pouches**, from local markets to Mumbai, Gokul's expansion was swift and smart. By **1988**, Gokul disrupted the monopoly in Mumbai's dairy market with the same dedication it began with cooperative spirit, fairness, and quality.

By **2005**, Gokul had launched ambitious programs like the **Calf Rearing Scheme** and **artificial insemination services**, fueling a new era of self-sufficient dairy farming in the region.

## *Chairman's Vision:* The Arun Dongale Era (2010– Present)

Under the bold leadership of **Shri Arun Ganpatrao Dongale**, Gokul transformed into a dynamic, tech-forward cooperative without compromising its grassroots values.

From **2010** onwards, Gokul implemented bulk milk cooler systems and launched **Gokul at Your Doorstep**, connecting directly with farmers at their cowsheds. Between **2011 and 2013**, annual milk procurement grew by **1 lakh liters** per year, peaking at **9 lakh liters in 2013**.

In 2024, Gokul celebrated its **Diamond Jubilee**, collecting over **17 lakh liters daily**, backed by facilities like a 450 MT/day **Mahalaxmi Cattle Feed Plant** and satellite dairies like **Shirod-Udgaw**. From **biogas initiatives** to **carbon credit linked subsidies for women farmers**, Gokul continues to walk the talk on sustainability and empowerment.

*Chairman Arun Dongale energetic and impactful leadership has introduced several new initiatives:*

AI services in every village

Premium milk procurement based on quality

Subsidies for livestock and sterilization camps

Fodder bank

Guidance and motivation for young dairy farmers

## Vision:

To be a leading cooperative dairy organization that uplifts rural dairy farmers while delivering high-quality, safe, and nutritious dairy products to consumers.





### Mission:

To ensure **fair and consistent remuneration** to milk producers.

To provide **veterinary services, feed, and breeding support** to farmers.

To adopt **modern technology and best practices** for milk procurement, processing, and distribution.

To promote **value-added dairy products** that meet evolving consumer needs.

To operate in a **sustainable and socially responsible manner**, protecting the environment and community welfare.

With this powerful foundation, Gokul Milk continues to inspire trust, nurture livelihoods, and serve as a role model for cooperative success in India's dairy sector.

### Milk Collection & Processing Capacity

Gokul Milk operates a state of the art dairy plant with a processing capacity of **17 lakh liters per day**. This is complemented by a satellite dairy at Udgaon, Taluka Shirol, and four owned chilling centers collectively handling **8 lakh liters per day**. Additionally, a modern packing unit in Navi Mumbai facilitates efficient distribution of dairy products.

In the fiscal year 2023-2024, Gokul achieved an average milk procurement of **14.70 lakh liters per day**, with a buffalo to cow milk ratio of 52:48.

### Dairy Farmer & Cooperative Network

Gokul's extensive network encompasses **7,927 dairy cooperative societies (DCS) across 1,825 villages**, connected through **508 milk procurement routes**.

The cooperative is associated with approximately **3,96,000 milch animal-owning households** in and around the Kolhapur district.







# Prokul<sup>®</sup>



## Ensuring Quality from Farm to Consumer

Gokul Milk is committed to delivering safe, hygienic, and high-quality milk and milk products. The organization adheres to Good Manufacturing Practices (GMP) at its plants to meet the requirements of the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) and other regulatory bodies.

### Key initiatives include:

**Veterinary Services:** Providing animal health care to ensure the well-being of milch animals.

**Artificial Insemination Centers:** Operating 430 cluster and 17 static centers to improve cattle breeds.

**Cattle Feed Plant:** Producing 200-300 MT/day of cattle feed to enhance milk yield.

### Sales Distribution: Liquid Milk vs. Value-Added Products

In the fiscal year 2023-2024, Gokul reported an average daily sale of **13.91 lakh liters** of liquid milk. While specific sales figures for value-added products are not publicly disclosed, the introduction of new products like flavored milk, Masala Buttermilk, and Mango Lassi indicates a strategic emphasis on expanding this segment to meet diverse consumer preferences.

## Main Products Offered by Gokul

Gokul's product range encompasses both staple dairy items and innovative offerings:

**Liquid Milk:** Standardized, Cow, Toned, and Full Cream Milk.

### Value-Added Products:

**Ghee:** Cow and Buffalo variants.

**Butter:** Table Butter and Cooking Butter.

**Paneer:** Fresh and hygienically processed.

**Curd (Dahi):** Thick and creamy texture.

**Lassi & Buttermilk:** Traditional Indian beverages.

**Shrikhand:** Available in flavors like Badam Pista, Mango, and Elaichi.

**Flavored Milk:** Chocolate, Strawberry, Vanilla, and Pista flavors.

**Skim Milk Powder:** Extra grade quality.

These products are widely available across markets, ensuring consistent quality and taste that have contributed to Gokul's growing market share.



## Domestic Market Reach

Gokul's products are widely distributed across Maharashtra, with significant penetration in major metropolitan areas:

**Mumbai:** Approximately 12 lakh liters of milk are supplied daily in pouches of half a liter and 1 liter.

**Pune:** Around 2.45 lakh liters of pouched milk are sold daily.

The company operates its own packaging unit in Navi Mumbai, facilitating efficient distribution in the region.

Beyond Maharashtra, Gokul has initiated the distribution of its UHT milk product, 'Gokul Select,' in other parts of India, including Delhi, Himachal Pradesh, Goa, and the northeastern regions

## International Presence :

While Gokul Milk's primary focus has been on the domestic market, its parent organization, Gokul currently exports to **Azerbaijan** and plans to expand further. It collaborates with reliable logistics partners to ensure timely and safe delivery of products. Regarding dairy exports, Gokul has maintained an Export Inspection License, indicating its capability to export dairy products

## Modernization and Automation in Processing Plants

Gokul Milk operates a state-of-the-art dairy plant with a processing capacity of 17 lakh liters per day. The facility includes advanced equipment for milk reception, pasteurization, homogenization, and packaging, ensuring efficiency and hygiene in operations.

In a significant move towards automation, Gokul has initiated the installation of an Automated Continuous Butter Making Plant with a capacity of 2 tons per hour. This plant encompasses features such as automated pasteurized cream transfer, butter milk handling, butter washing, jacket cooling systems, moisture dosing, fat recovery, and a Clean-In-Place (CIP) system. The integration of such advanced machinery underscores Gokul's dedication to enhancing product quality and operational efficiency.

## Innovations in Packaging and Cold Chain Logistics

Gokul Milk has established a modern packing unit in Navi Mumbai, facilitating efficient packaging and distribution of its dairy products. The company employs robust cold chain logistics to maintain the freshness and quality of its products during transportation and storage. This includes temperature controlled environments and real-time monitoring systems to ensure that dairy products reach consumers in optimal condition.











### **Advancements in Quality Control**

Quality assurance is a cornerstone of Gokul Milk's operations. The company adheres to stringent quality control measures, including regular testing of milk and dairy products for purity, nutritional content, and safety. By leveraging modern analytical tools and adhering to industry best practices, Gokul ensures that its products meet the highest standards of quality and safety.

### **Empowering Dairy Farmers: Initiatives for Welfare**

Gokul Milk's foundation rests on the strength and prosperity of its dairy farmers. Recognizing their pivotal role, Gokul has implemented a range of initiatives aimed at enhancing their livelihoods and ensuring sustainable dairy farming practices.

### **Veterinary and Breeding Services:**

Gokul operates 46 mobile veterinary routes and 406 cluster Artificial Insemination (AI) centers, providing essential animal healthcare and breeding services to farmers.

### **Cattle Feed Production:**

The cooperative runs a state-of-the-art cattle feed plant with a capacity of 450 MT/day, producing the popular 'Mahalaxmi' brand feed, ensuring nutritious diets for livestock.

### **Training and Development:**

Through the Anandrao D. Patil Dugdh Vyavasay and Animal Husbandry Training Centre, established with assistance from the National Dairy Development Board (NDDB), Gokul offers training programs focusing on human resource development and institutional building.

### **Women Empowerment:**

Gokul has formulated programs to promote women's involvement in dairy cooperatives, fostering inclusiveness and enhancing their participation in the dairy sector.

### **Sustainability:**

Commitment to Environmental Stewardship Understanding the environmental impact of dairy operations, Gokul Milk has adopted several sustainable practices to minimize its ecological footprint.

### **Renewable Energy Utilization:**

Gokul has invested in renewable energy sources, including biogas and solar energy, to power its operations, reducing reliance on conventional energy and lowering carbon emissions.

### **Water Conservation:**

While specific details are not publicly disclosed, Gokul's commitment to sustainability suggests the implementation of water recycling and conservation measures in its processing plants.



### **Eco-Friendly Packaging:**

Gokul has introduced packaging solutions that are recyclable and environmentally friendly, aligning with global trends in sustainable dairy packaging.

### **Robust Sales Performance**

In the financial year 2023–24, Gokul Milk achieved an impressive turnover of ₹3,670.09 crore, reflecting its strong market presence and efficient operations. The dairy plant processed a total of 60.07 crore liters of milk during this period, underscoring its capacity to meet substantial consumer demand.

### **Expansion of Processing Capabilities**

To meet the growing demand for dairy products and improve efficiency, Gokul Milk is investing in the establishment of a new Continuous Butter Making Machine (CBMM) with a capacity of 2.0 tons per hour. This state-of-the-art facility will be integrated into the existing dairy plant and will include automated systems for cream transfer, butter production, and packaging, ensuring high-quality output and operational efficiency.

### **Renewable Energy Initiatives**

In line with its commitment to sustainability, Gokul Milk is undertaking significant steps to reduce its environmental footprint. The cooperative is in the process of setting up a 6.5 MWp rooftop solar power plant under the open access captive scheme.

This initiative aims to meet the energy needs of its facilities through renewable sources, thereby promoting energy efficiency and reducing reliance on conventional power grids.

### **Product Portfolio Diversification**

Gokul Milk continues to innovate its product offerings to cater to evolving consumer preferences. While specific details about upcoming products are not publicly disclosed, the cooperative's ongoing investments in processing technology and market research suggest a focus on introducing new dairy products that align with health trends and consumer demands.

### **Market Expansion and Digital Engagement**

Recognizing the importance of digital platforms in today's market, Gokul Milk is enhancing its online presence to facilitate easier access to its products. The cooperative is exploring partnerships with e-commerce platforms and improving its digital marketing strategies to reach a broader consumer base, both within and outside Maharashtra.





## Message to Consumers, Dairy Farmers, and Stakeholders

At Gokul Milk, we extend our heartfelt gratitude to all our valued consumers, dedicated dairy farmers, and esteemed stakeholders. Your unwavering trust and support have been instrumental in our journey of over six decades in the dairy industry.

### To Our Loyal Consumers:

Your preference for Gokul Milk reflects your confidence in our commitment to quality and purity. We pledge to continue delivering wholesome dairy products that meet the highest standards, ensuring that every drop of milk brings nutrition and satisfaction to your homes.

### To Our Dedicated Dairy Farmers:

You are the backbone of our success. Your hard work and dedication enable us to serve millions of households across the region. We remain committed to supporting you through fair pricing, veterinary services, training programs, and sustainable farming practices, empowering you to thrive and grow.

### To Our Esteemed Stakeholders:

Your collaboration and partnership have been vital in our endeavors. Together, we have built a robust and resilient dairy ecosystem that serves as a model for others. We look forward to strengthening our bonds and achieving greater milestones in the years to come.

Let us continue to work hand in hand, fostering growth, sustainability, and prosperity for all involved.

*Thank you for being an integral part of the Gokul family.*





## **Here are Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) from an importer's perspective looking to do business with Gokul Milk :**

### **What dairy products does Gokul offer for export?**

Gokul offers a range of dairy products including Butter, ghee, skimmed milk powder (SMP), paneer, shrikhand, basundi, and flavored milk.

### **What is the minimum order quantity (MOQ) for exports?**

The MOQ is 1 full container per order, with options for bulk packaging in 25 kg or 20 kg.

### **What are your payment terms for export orders?**

Payment terms are 100% advance for all export orders

### **What certifications does Gokul hold to ensure compliance with international standards?**

Gokul holds ISO 22000:2018, ISO 9001:2015 certifications, an Export Inspection License, and Halal Certification for suitable products.

### **Which countries do you export to, and how reliable is your logistics?**

Gokul currently exports to Azerbaijan and plans to expand further. It collaborates with reliable logistics partners to ensure timely and safe delivery of products.







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 2nd floor of bhandare cloth center, Bidri, Kolhapur , 416208